LESSON PACK · WEEK 6 · LESSON 1 · NOW OR ALWAYS

Always or now

Grammar · Present simple vs present continuous

Words · Change and decisions

BY THE END YOU CAN SAY

I usually walk to school, but today I'm taking the bus.

She works in a bank, but now she's having lunch.

WARM-UP · BEGINNER IS STILL ALIVE

Let's talk first

1. Beginner: What do you usually do after school? Say two things.
   Beginner: Что ты обычно делаешь после школы? Скажи две вещи.

2. What are you doing now? Say a sentence.
   Что ты делаешь сейчас? Скажи предложение.

DID YOU KNOW?

Always, usually, every day = present simple. Now, today, at the moment = present continuous.

Always, usually, every day = present simple. Now, today, at the moment = present continuous.

CORE WORDS 1 / 2

Today's 20 words

R **replace**
заменять

B **begin**
начинать

I **improve**
улучшать(ся)

C **continue**
продолжать

D **develop**
развивать(ся)

S **stop**
останавливать(ся)

I **increase**
увеличивать(ся)

T **try**
пытаться

B **become**
становиться

M **manage**
справляться

CORE WORDS 2 / 2

Today's 20 words

D **decide** — решать

E **expect** — ожидать

R **remember** — помнить

H **hope** — надеяться

F **forget** — забывать

W **wish** — желать

N **notice** — замечать

P **pretend** — притворяться

R **realize** — осознавать

G **gather** — собирать(ся)

EXTRA WORDS 1 / 2 · ONLY IF YOU WANT MORE

20 extra words, easy to use

M
moment
момент

P
past
прошлое

P
period
период

A
ancient times
древние времена

C
century
век

R
recently
недавно

D
decade
десятилетие

L
lately
в последнее время

G
generation
поколение

N
nowadays
в наши дни

EXTRA WORDS 2 / 2 · ONLY IF YOU WANT MORE

20 extra words, easy to use

C **currently**
в настоящее время

Y **yet**
ещё

S **suddenly**
внезапно

S **still**
всё ещё

S **shortly**
вскоре

A **again**
снова

A **afterwards**
впоследствии

F **forever**
навсегда

A **already**
уже

S **sometime**
когда-нибудь

HOW IT WORKS · 1

Two tenses, two ideas

Present simple

every day · always · usually · often · never — habits and facts

Present continuous

now · right now · today · at the moment — happening now

I walk to school (every day).
Я хожу пешком (каждый день).

I'm taking the bus (today).
Я еду на автобусе (сегодня).

HOW IT WORKS · 2

Which tense?

I usually walk to school. ✓

Я обычно хожу в школу пешком.

Today I'm taking the bus. ✓

Сегодня я еду на автобусе.

She works in a bank. Now she's having lunch. ✓

Она работает в банке. Сейчас она обедает.

Habit = present simple: I walk, she works

Привычка = present simple

Now = present continuous: I'm taking, she's having

Сейчас = present continuous

Look at the time word: every day ≠ now

Смотри на слово-сигнал

HOW IT WORKS · 3

Ask both questions

Do you walk to school?

No, I take the bus. Today I'm walking.

Ты ходишь в школу пешком? Нет, я езжу на автобусе. Сегодня иду пешком.

What are you doing now?

I'm reading. I read every evening.

Что ты делаешь сейчас? Я читаю. Я читаю каждый вечер.

Do you ...? (habit) · Are you ...-ing? (now)

Do you...? (привычка) · Are you ...-ing? (сейчас)

Answer with the same tense

Отвечай в том же времени

But shows the contrast: usually ... but today ...

But показывает контраст

WATCH OUT

Four mistakes to avoid

I am walking to school every day. ✗ → **I walk to school every day.** ✓

every day → simple

She works now. ✗ → **She is working now.** ✓

now → continuous

He always is late. ✗ → **He is always late.** ✓

always after is

Today I take the bus. ✗ → **Today I'm taking the bus.** ✓

today → -ing

EXAMPLE SENTENCES

Look and say

I usually walk to school.
Я обычно хожу в школу пешком.

Today I'm taking the bus.
Сегодня я еду на автобусе.

She works in a bank.
Она работает в банке.

Now she's having lunch.
Сейчас она обедает.

My father drinks tea every morning.
Папа пьёт чай каждое утро.

Right now he's drinking coffee.
Сейчас он пьёт кофе.

They play football on Saturdays.
Они играют в футбол по субботам.

Today they're playing basketball.
Сегодня они играют в баскетбол.

WORDS THAT GO TOGETHER

Collocations and phrasal verbs

5 COLLOCATIONS

make a decision
принять решение

change your mind
передумать

make progress
делать успехи

keep trying
продолжать пытаться

take a break
сделать перерыв

2 PHRASAL VERBS

give up
сдаваться

carry on
продолжать

Make one sentence with each of them. They are part of today's homework.

SPEAKING

Usually vs today

1. **Write 3 things you usually do. Write 3 things you are doing differently today.**
2. **Tell your partner: I usually walk, but today I'm taking the bus.**
3. **Ask a question with Do or Are: Do you usually…? Are you … today?**
4. **Tell the class about your partner.**

EXAMPLE

A **I usually walk to school, but today I'm taking the bus.**

B **Why are you taking the bus today?**

A **It's raining! What do you usually do?**

B **I usually take the bus.**

Choose the tense by the time word: every day / usually → simple; now / today → continuous.

PLAY TO PRACTICE

Games with a working link

Baamboozle: Present Simple or Present Continuous?

https://www.baamboozle.com/game/936512

Choose the right tense for each sentence and say why (every day → simple, now → continuous). Game code 936512.

On the laptop: click the link, press **Play**, choose 2 to 4 teams. All pages were opened and checked on 21 Oct 2026.

LISTENING

Watch and listen

VOA Let's Learn English, Level 1, Lesson 2: Hello, I'm Anna!

https://learningenglish.voanews.com/a/lets-learn-english-lesson-2-hello/3113733.html

Video lesson with text and exercises.

VOA Let's Learn English, Level 1, Lesson 52: Taking Chances

https://learningenglish.voanews.com/a/lets-learn-english-lesson-52-taking-chances/3805454.html

Video lesson with text and exercises.

VOA Let's Learn English, Level 1, Lesson 43: Time for Plan B

https://learningenglish.voanews.com/a/lets-learn-english-lesson-43-time-for-plan-b/3666458.html

Video lesson with text and exercises.

Pick the one you like. First for the main idea, then again with the text.

LAST 5 MINUTES

Say it! Exit check

1. Say: I / usually / walk to school
2. Say: today / I / take the bus
3. Say: she / work / now
4. Correct it: I am walking to school every day.
5. Beginner: What do you usually do after school?

Ask aloud, one student at a time. The answers are on the last page.

LAST 10 MINUTES

Speak! Recap with questions

1. What do you usually do after school?
2. What are you doing now?
3. Do you usually walk to school?
4. How are you getting home today?
5. What does your mother usually cook?
6. What is she cooking today?
7. What do you usually wear?
8. What are you wearing today?

Ask in pairs, then ask the whole class. Perfect sentences, please: stop and repeat if there is a mistake.

TEACHER · ANSWERS

Answer key · exercises

1 · Simple or continuous?

1. walk · 2. am taking · 3. works · 4. is having · 5. drinks · 6. is drinking

2 · Choose the tense

1. play · 2. are playing · 3. is · 4. is singing · 5. study

3 · Put the words in order

1. I usually walk to school. · 2. Today I'm taking the bus. · 3. She works in a bank. · 4. Now she's having lunch. · 5. My father drinks tea every morning.

4 · Find and correct the mistake

1. I walk to school every day. · 2. She is working now. · 3. He is always late. · 4. Today I'm taking the bus. · 5. They play football on Saturdays.

5 · Read and write T (true) or F (false)

1. T · 2. F · 3. T · 4. T · 5. F

6 · Always or today?

Personal answers. Check simple for habits and continuous for today.

TEACHER · ANSWERS

Answer key · exit check and homework

EXIT CHECK

1. Say: I / usually / walk to school → I usually walk to school.
2. Say: today / I / take the bus → Today I'm taking the bus.
3. Say: she / work / now → She is working now.
4. Correct it: I am walking to school every day. → I walk to school every day.
5. Beginner: What do you usually do after school? → Personal answers.

RUSSIAN → ENGLISH

1. Я обычно хожу в школу пешком. → I usually walk to school.
2. Сегодня я еду на автобусе. → Today I'm taking the bus.
3. Она работает в банке. → She works in a bank.
4. Сейчас она обедает. → Now she's having lunch.
5. Папа пьёт чай каждое утро. → My father drinks tea every morning.
6. Сейчас он пьёт кофе. → Right now he's drinking coffee.
7. Они играют в футбол по субботам. → They play football on Saturdays.
8. Сегодня они играют в баскетбол. → Today they're playing basketball.
9. Что ты обычно делаешь после школы? → What do you usually do after school?
10. Что ты делаешь сейчас? → What are you doing now?